

Ideation Phase

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template

Date	18 June 2026
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Project Name	ShopEZ-E-Commerce-Application
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template:

Brainstorming provides a free and open environment that encourages everyone within a team to participate in the creative thinking process that leads to problem solving. Prioritizing volume over value, out-of-the-box ideas are welcome and built upon, and all participants are encouraged to collaborate, helping each other develop a rich amount of creative solutions.

Use this template in your own brainstorming sessions so your team can unleash their imagination and start shaping concepts even if you're not sitting in the same room.

Step-1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement

The team gathered to scope the ShopEZ MERN e-commerce platform and align on the core challenge it needed to solve before any design or coding began. The discussion centred on what an everyday online shopper struggles with, and what a small store-owner / admin needs to run their catalog and orders without friction.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

How might we build an online shopping platform that lets customers browse, filter, and buy products with complete confidence and ease, while giving store admins a simple, reliable way to manage the catalog, track orders, and grow the business?

Team Gathering & Roles

- Participants: Developer/Team Lead (Dhanish Ladwani) and supporting contributors covering frontend (React/Vite), backend (Node/Express), and database (MongoDB) responsibilities.
- Pre-work shared before the session: competitor e-commerce flows, common cart/checkout pain points, and a list of must-have admin capabilities (product CRUD, order status tracking, analytics).
- Key rules followed during the session: stay on topic, defer judgment, go for volume, encourage wild ideas, listen to others, and stay visual wherever possible.

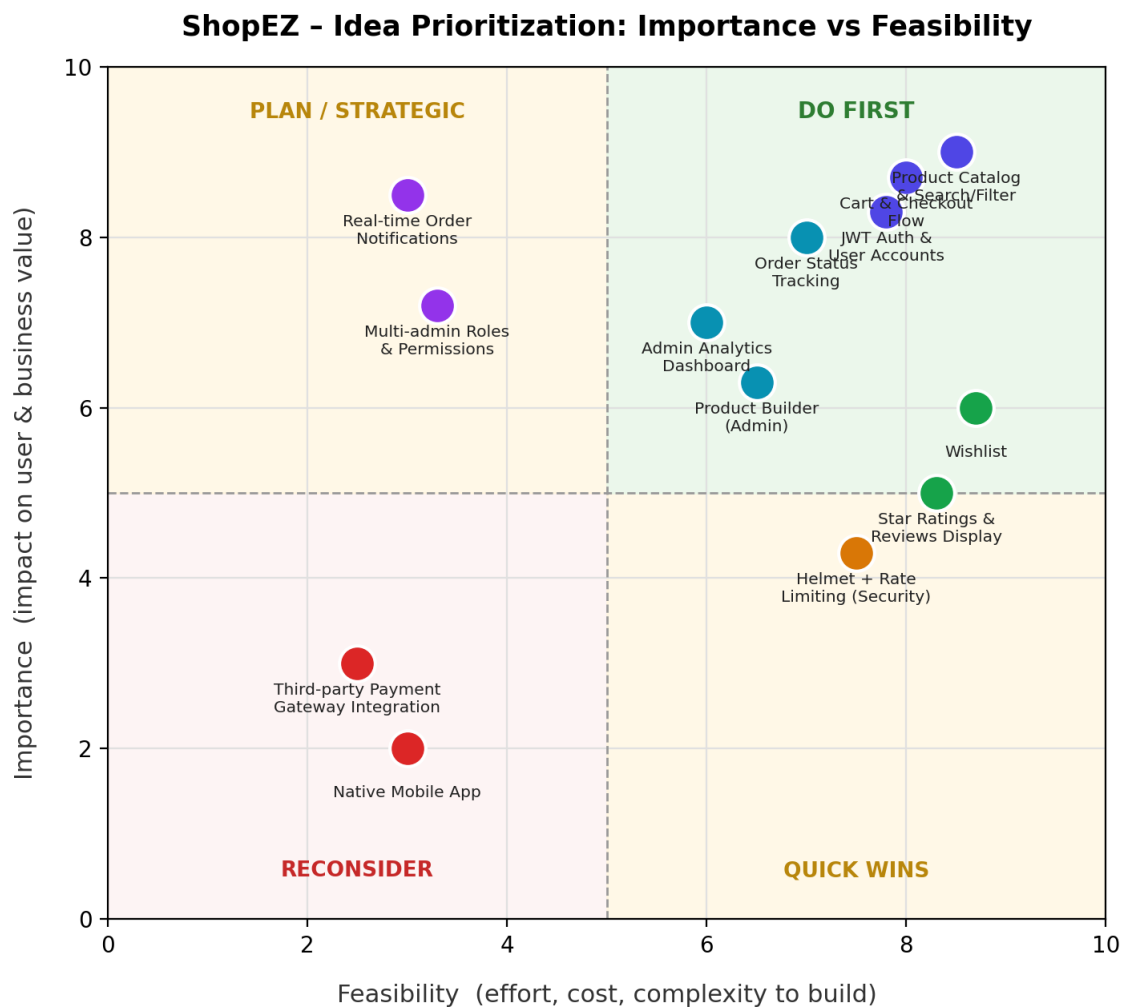
Step-2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

Each team member contributed ideas addressing the problem statement. The raw ideas were then clustered into four sentence-like groups based on theme.

Group A – Customer Shopping Experience - Real-time search with gender & category filters - Sort by price / discount - Star ratings & review counts on listings - Wishlist to save favourite products - Dynamic cart with live quantity sync	Group B – Order & Checkout Flow - Transparent checkout with order history - Order status tracking (placed → delivered) - Expected delivery date display - JWT-secured login & persisted sessions - Editable user profile
Group C – Admin Control Panel - Analytics dashboard: revenue, orders, top sellers - Product builder with live preview - Order fulfillment & status updates - User auditing & account management	Group D – Security, Performance & Trust - Helmet-secured HTTP headers - Rate limiting on auth & API routes - Password hashing via bcryptjs - Response compression for faster loads

Step-3: Idea Prioritization

The grouped ideas were plotted on an Importance vs. Feasibility grid to decide what the team should build first. Items in the top-right (high importance, high feasibility) became the MVP scope for ShopEZ; items in the top-left were noted as future roadmap items requiring more planning or third-party integration.



Outcome of Prioritization

1. **Do First (built into ShopEZ v1):** Product catalog with search/filter, cart & checkout, JWT authentication, order status tracking, admin analytics dashboard, and product builder.
2. **Quick Wins (included as enhancements):** Wishlist, star ratings/review display, and security middleware (Helmet, rate limiting).
3. **Plan / Strategic (future roadmap):** Real-time order notifications and multi-admin roles/permissions, deferred pending further design.
4. **Reconsider (out of scope for now):** Third-party payment gateway integration and a native mobile app, both high-effort and lower priority for the current release.